HONG (IVY) ZHAN

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Website | GitHub | LinkedIn

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Trust in generative AI, cross-platform information evaluation, and participation in online communities, using computational and qualitative methods.

EDUCATION

University of York, York, UK 2022 – 2024
MSc in Social Media and Management, with Merit
Selected coursework: Research Design; Understanding Social Media; Social Media, Data & Society.

Wuchang University of Technology, Wuhan, China 2017 – 2021
BEng in Computer Science and Technology
Selected coursework: Probability and Mathematical Statistics; Data Structures; Software Modeling; Software Testing.

MANUSCRIPTS

Zhan, H. (2026). Beyond the Aggregate: Trust and Distrust in Generative AI Across Technical Reddit Communities and Time. *Manuscript submitted to Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW).* Sole author.
Data & code: Zenodo record | GitHub repository

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Generative AI Trust and Distrust in Technical Reddit Communities
Sole-author research Feb 2026 – Oct 2026

- Found close pooled shares of *Neither* (neither trust nor distrust; 41.7%) and *Trust* (40.0%), with different community orderings: Trust led in r/ChatGPTCoding and r/programming; Neither led in r/webdev, r/GitHub, and r/compsci.
- Designed a secondary analysis of released data from five technical Reddit communities, analyzing 8,519 classification records and 4,964 dimension records separately by community and half-year in Python and R.
- Documented data sources, missing labels, and sparse periods; distinguished the substitute dimension analysis from replication of the source study.

Cross-Platform Social Media Use and Information Practices
MSc dissertation research | University of York Feb 2023 – Sep 2023

- Designed and conducted 15 semi-structured interviews (approximately 60 minutes each) on cross-platform social media use and cultural adaptation among Chinese students in the UK.
- Transcribed interviews and coded them thematically in NVivo; analyzed social media posts. Identified platform-specific communication, language barriers, and cross-platform credibility checking.

Recruitment Management System
BEng Graduation Thesis (Design) | Wuchang University of Technology Feb 2021 – Jun 2021

- Translated recruitment workflow requirements into interaction flows and prototypes; implemented job posting, application tracking, and candidate management using Spring Boot and MySQL.
- Evaluated recruitment workflows through think-aloud usability testing with 8 participants; used findings to guide interface revisions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Strategy Analyst | TikTok Shop, London, UK Sep 2024 – Jan 2026

- Analyzed UK e-commerce performance across merchant growth, product operations, and content-driven sales; monitored KPIs and investigated performance trends.
- Supported cross-functional strategic initiatives, business reviews, and operational improvements through analysis of merchant and product performance.

Founder & Operations Manager | Zero Point HR, Wuhan, China Aug 2019 – Sep 2022

- Built a recruitment operations platform coordinating approximately 30 staff and matching job seekers with employers.
- Designed candidate-screening, shift-scheduling, and placement-tracking workflows supporting 3,000+ full-time placements and 100,000+ part-time shifts.

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Tech Volunteer | BetaNYC, New York, USA Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Prepared NYC public datasets and accessible visualizations for open-data and civic-tech workshops; engaged residents on barriers to accessing government information.

Data Volunteer | DataKind, London, UK Dec 2023 – Jul 2024

- Cleaned and analyzed nonprofit service data with Python/pandas in a DataDive; produced visualizations and a stakeholder briefing to inform program decisions.

International Student Buddy | University of York, York, UK Oct 2022 – Sep 2023

- Mentored international students transitioning to university life, providing practical guidance and connecting them with campus resources and student communities.

RESEARCH METHODS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Methods: Research design; semi-structured interviews; thematic analysis; think-aloud usability testing; descriptive statistics; data validation, provenance, and reproducibility.

Programming & analysis: Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib), R, SQL, NVivo.

Design & systems: Requirements analysis, interaction design, Figma, web development, Spring Boot, MySQL.

Research workflow: Git/GitHub, LaTeX.

LANGUAGES

English (fluent); Chinese (native).